Manuel Holz

Quantitative Social Scientist · Data Scientist · Lecturer

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Chemnitz, Germany

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Associate
2017–present

Professorship Empirical Social Research, Chemnitz University of Technology

Research and teaching quantitative methods

Lecturer (temporary)
2025

Professorship Empirical Social Research, RPTU University Kaiserslautern-Landau

Introduction to social data analytics in R

PROJECTS

Norms in medical triage situations in the context of AI
2026–present

Medical treatment allocation preferences, discrete choice experiments.

Sponsor: Fritz Thyssen Foundation

Concepts for urban housing mobilization (Zukowo)
2026–present

Housing preferences, spatial data, vignette experiments, and interactive visualization.

Sponsor: Federal Ministry of Research, Technology and Space of Germany (BMFTR)

Come2Data - Competence Center for Interdisciplinary Data Sciences
2023–2026

Training and support in the fields of data integration, data management, data analysis and data publication

Sponsor: Federal Ministry of Research, Technology and Space of Germany (BMFTR, 16DKZ2044B)

COVID-19 Skepticism & Infection Dynamics
2022–2025

Longitudinal analysis combining survey, epidemiological and social media data

Sponsor: Development Bank of Saxony (SAB)

Societal acceptance of sustainable technologies
2019–2022

Two-wave panel on attitudes towards green technologies in housing

Sponsor: Federal Ministry of Research, Technology and Space of Germany (BMFTR, 033W108A-K)

EDUCATION

PhD in Sociology (*Dr. rer. soc.*) — 2024

Chemnitz University of Technology

Dissertation: Explaining migrant health inequalities - selection, measurement invariance and working conditions in native-migrant health differences (*summa cum laude*)

Supervisors: **Prof. Dr. Jochen Mayerl, Prof. Dr. Peter Kriwy**

M.Sc. Socioeconomics — 2017

University of Erlangen-Nuremberg

Thesis: Aspects of the Healthy Migrant Effect

Supervisors: **Prof. Dr. Andreas Damelang, Prof. Dr. Martin Abraham**

B.A. Socioeconomics — 2014

University of Erlangen-Nuremberg

Supervisors: **Prof. Dr. Peter Kriwy, Prof. Dr. Monika Jungbauer-Gans**

ACADEMIC & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Communication Officer — 2026–present

Research Network 21 Quantitative Methods (RN21) of the European Sociological Association (ESA)

Member, PPES Study Programme Committee — 2025–present

Philosophy, Politics, Economics & Sociology (PPES)

Member, Deutschlandstipendium Scholarship Selection Committee — 2023–present

Chemnitz University of Technology

Erasmus Exchange Coordinator — 2018–present

Chemnitz University of Technology

Summer School — 2025

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, Paris

Internship — 2016

German Institute for Economic Research (DIW), Berlin

Web scraping of nuclear power plant data

Supervisors: **Prof. Dr. Claudia Kemfert, Prof. Dr. Christian von Hirschhausen**

Internship — 2014

Institute for Empirical Sociology, Nuremberg

Data management and visualization of sustainable mobility data

Supervisor: **Prof. Dr. Walter Funk**

Exchange — 2016

Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México

Exchange 2013
Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona

SKILLS & CERTIFICATES

Programming
R · Python · SQL · STATA

Tools & workflow
Quarto · Git · LaTeX · VS Code

Certificates
Nature Masterclass Peer Review · Kaggle Advanced SQL

Languages
German (native) · English · French · Spanish · Italian · Russian

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Holz, M., Mayerl, J., & Kriwy, P. (2026). *The Social Dynamics of Pandemic Outcomes: Linking Social Media Discourse, Infection Rates, Political Attitudes and Health Beliefs.* SSRN (preprint) DOI: 10.2139/ssrn.7471201

Schwemmer, C., Block, S., Jaworeck, S., Holz, M., & Spielbauer, P. (2026). *Simplifying Sociology: When Complex Writing Occurs, Where It Matters, and How It Can Be Improved.* OSF (preprint) DOI: /10.31235/osf.io/7gjzf_v2

Holz, M., Andersen, H., & Mayerl, J. (2026). *Visualizing Data for Social Science Research: An Applied Introduction with R.* Springer VS DOI: 10.1007/978-3-658-50878-4

Holz, M., Gränitz, J., Mayerl, J., & Kriwy, P. (2026). *Computational Approaches to Assessing the Influence of Social Media Discourse on Pandemic Attitudes.* Soziale Welt Special Volume: Computational Social Science: Current Trends and State of the Art.

Zehner, A. H., Fölsch, M., Menold, N., Holz, M., Maskow, B., & Mayerl, J. (2026). *Foreigners welcome? Categorizing change in German mass media discourse with Latent Semantic Analysis (LSA).* PLOS ONE, 21(2), e0340164. DOI: 10.1371/journal.pone.0340164

Holz, M., & Mayerl, J. (2025). *Can Differing Occupational Class Positions Explain Migrant Health Inequalities? Differences in Trajectories of Subjective Health Between Migrants and Native Germans over Time.* KZfSS Kölner Zeitschrift für Soziologie und Sozialpsychologie, 77(1), 27–52. DOI: 10.1007/s11577-025-00985-3

Holz, M., & Mayerl, J. (2024). *Migrant Health Inequalities or Unequal Measurements? Testing for Cross-cultural and Longitudinal Measurement Invariance of Subjective Physical and Mental Health.* Methods, data, analyses: a journal for quantitative methods and survey methodology, 18(1), 59–78. DOI: 10.12758/mda.2024.01

Holz, M. (2022). *Health inequalities in Germany: Differences in the 'Healthy migrant effect' of European, non-European and internal migrants.* Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies, 48(11), 2620–2641. DOI: 10.1080/1369183X.2021.1901675

Holz, M., Mayerl, J., Andersen, H., & Maskow, B. (2022). *How does migration background affect COVID-19 vaccination intentions? A complex relationship between general attitudes, religiosity, acculturation and fears of infection.* Frontiers in Public Health, 10, 854146. DOI: 10.3389/fpubh.2022.854146

SELECTED CONFERENCE CONTRIBUTIONS

2025. *Contextualizing surveys: Incorporating digital trace and media data.* Session Chair, European Survey Research Association (ESRA), Utrecht, Netherlands.

Holz, M., Zehner, A., & Mayerl, J. (2026). *Did Gen Z Stop Loving University? Changing Perceptions of University Education Among Adolescent Cohorts – Evidence from Longitudinal Data.*

Presentation, European Sociological Association (ESA), Warsaw, Poland.

Holz, M., Planche, V., Buder, C., Tolepbergen, M., & Belgroun, H. (2026). *Constructing the AI Narrative: Techno-Optimism and Techno-Pessimism in Wikipedia's Discourse on Technological Issues.* Presentation, European Sociological Association (ESA), Warsaw, Poland.

Holz, M., Maskow, B., Mayerl, J., Zehner, A., & Menold, N. (2025). *Predicting migrant acceptance: Investigating the impact of social media discourse on public perceptions of migration.* Presentation, International Sociological Association (ISA) RC33 Conference, Naples, Italy. DOI: 10.13140/RG.2.2.16156.55683

Holz, M., & Mayerl, J. (2025). *Lost in translation? Migration, panel attrition and language versions in health surveys: Evidence from the German Socio-Economic Panel.* Presentation, Between Data and Dialogue: Focusing on Participants in Migration Research – IMISCOE Workshop, Chemnitz, Germany.

Jaworeck, S., & Holz, M. (2023). *Different methods, but same results? A comparison of Causal Forest and Propensity Score Matching on health disparities between natives and migrants.* Presentation, Analytical Sociology: Theory and Empirical Applications, Venice, Italy.

Holz, M., Adebahr, P., Mayerl, J., & Kriwy, P. (2023). *Merging Survey, Epidemiological and Twitter Data: Challenges of data integration (and implications for model effects).* Presentation, European Survey Research Association (ESRA), Milan, Italy.

Holz, M., & Mayerl, J. (2023). *A gender jab gap? COVID-19 vaccination intention and the interplay of migration background and gender.* Presentation, Institute for Employment Research (IAB) Networking Meeting on Migration and Gender, Nuremberg, Germany.